service rather than literally.

In some senses, today's BJP leaders seem closer in spirit and conviction to the Hindu Rashtra of Savarkar and Golwalkar than to that of Upadhyaya. Not for them the partial generosity of acknowledging the place and role of the Muslims and Christians in the country; these are less tolerant men and women (one of the latter, after all, a Minister in the Modi government, divided the nation into Ramzaade, believers in Rama, and Haramzaade, bastards).[55] Where Deen Dayal harked back to ancient India's generosity in offering asylum to Parsis and Jews,[56] today's BJP government announces its determination to expel Rohingya Muslim asylum-seekers[57] because they happen to be Muslim, and therefore ipso facto are assumed to constitute a threat to India's security. Where Upadhyaya denounced materialism and embodied the virtues of a simple village life, preached the abolition of large landholdings and spoke up for the humble peasant, his followers in power swear by GDP growth and fiscal balance, subsidise the multi-billion pound ventures of capitalist cronies, sport imported designer sunglasses, wield Mont Blanc pens and wear the highest-quality tailored linens. Their slogans are not about the poor in India's villages, nor about the soul-force that animates this ancient civilisation, but about 'ease of doing business' and 'start-up India'. Where Upadhyaya deplored materialism and extolled self-reliance, the men ruling in his name exalt figures of GDP growth and clamour for Foreign Direct Investment; his injunctions against an excessive attachment to affluence and *prabhav (*or socio-economic distinctions) are ignored by rulers who crave the support of billionaires.

Upadhyaya believed that after Independence India lost its idealism, because by failing to create a Hindu Rashtra, it never recognised one grand uniting force to hold Indians together. It could be argued that for all its claims of supplying this force, Hindutva actually works by replacing hatred for the British with hatred for a minority—a formula that will result in division and destruction, not unity. I have often argued that we are all minorities in India, given our divisions of language, region, caste and cultural practices. Recognising and managing that diversity is a far better way of promoting unity than imposing one view